Chapter 4
Truth Force

When he finished his work on the court case in Pretoria, Gandhi felt that he still had a job to do. “Thus God laid the foundations of my life in South Africa, and sowed the seed of the fight for national self-respect,” Gandhi wrote. In 1894, Gandhi set up the Natal Indian Congress so that Indians could be involved in government. Gandhi was becoming a leader in the Indian community.



Indians had very few rights in the colonies and territories in South Africa. They had to pay extra taxes. They could not walk on public footpaths. They could not go out after nine at night without a permit. They were told that the only legal marriages were between Christians, so their own marriages were considered invalid. They were not allowed to vote for their leaders. Gandhi remembered one night when a police officer shoved him off a sidewalk: “Once, one of these men, without giving me the slightest warning, without even asking me to leave the footpath, pushed and kicked me into the street.”